

The Clockwork Cosmology: Gravity and Cosmic Dynamics as a Function of a Variable Time-Rate in Euclidean Space

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June 13, 2026

Abstract

This paper presents an alternative, self-contained cosmological model—the *Clockwork Cosmology*—which describes the phenomena of gravitation and cosmic redshift without assuming a four-dimensional spacetime curvature or an expansion of space (Big Bang hypothesis). The model postulates an absolutely flat, infinite, and rigid Euclidean space filled with a dynamic coordinate medium termed the *Time-Aether*. Physical masses locally condense this aether, resulting in a spatially dependent deceleration of the fundamental time-rate (T). The mechanical motion of bodies in space (gravitation) is defined as a purely local drift along this gradient, mathematically formulated by the universal equation of motion $\vec{a} = c_0^2 \cdot \vec{\nabla}T$. It is demonstrated that this formulation, via the field equation of the Time-Aether $T = 1 - \frac{G \cdot M}{c_0^2 r}$, converges exactly to Newton’s law of universal gravitation in the classical limit. Furthermore, historical obstacles of alternative theories are resolved: cosmic redshift is explained as a collinear, coherent, and adiabatic stretching of light waves within the large-scale structure of the Time-Aether, preventing image degradation. Gravitational light deflection, including the relativistic factor of 2, is derived using Huygens’ principle of wave optics via global velocity refraction within the density gradient. Finally, the PHARAO project (ACES mission) on the International Space Station (ISS) is proposed as a near-term empirical cross-test for the theory.

1 Introduction and Physical Axioms

Modern astrophysics relies heavily on the geometric interpretation of gravitation as the curvature of a four-dimensional spacetime manifold, alongside the paradigm of an expanding universe initiated by a singular Big Bang event. While mathematically robust, these frameworks necessitate the introduction of highly hypothetical constructs, such as Dark Matter and Dark Energy, to align with observed galactic rotation curves and cosmic acceleration.

The *Clockwork Cosmology* proposed herein offers a paradigm shift by returning to a classical, rigid, and infinite three-dimensional Euclidean space. The core axioms of this model are defined as follows:

1. **Absolute Euclidean Space:** Space is flat, non-dynamic, and infinite. It acts purely as a rigid stage and undergoes no physical bending, stretching, or metric expansion.
2. **The Time-Aether:** Space is permeated by a continuous, fundamental coordinate medium termed the Time-Aether. This medium dictates the localized rate of temporal progression, or the cosmic “clockwork.”

3. **Mass Interaction:** Matter acts as a sink or condensing agent for the Time-Aether. The presence of physical mass (M) increases the local density of the aether, which inherently decelerates the local passage of time (T).

2 The Mathematical Foundation

The mechanics of the Clockwork Cosmology are governed by two primary equations that bridge localized temporal gradients with deterministic physical acceleration.

2.1 The Universal Equation of Motion

Instead of traveling along geodesics in a curved manifold, a physical object reacts to the spatial anisotropy of the temporal progression rate. Acceleration is driven by a local drift toward the slowest temporal progression:

$$\vec{a} = c_0^2 \cdot \vec{\nabla} T \quad (1)$$

2.2 The Field Equation of the Time-Aether

The local time-rate factor (T) in the vicinity of a spherical, non-rotating mass (M) at a rigid geometric distance (r) is determined by the field equation:

$$T = 1 - \frac{G \cdot M}{c_0^2 \cdot r} \quad (2)$$

Table 1: Nomenclature and Physical Definitions within the Model

Symbol	Term	Physical Interpretation
$\vec{a}$	Acceleration Vector	The observable physical acceleration, always directed toward the steepest gradient of temporal deceleration.
c_0	Aether Constant	The maximum propagation and oscillation velocity within the unperturbed medium ($\approx 300,000$ km/s on Earth).
$\vec{\nabla}$	Nabla Operator	The spatial gradient measuring the slope and direction of the local time-rate anisotropy.
T	Time-Rate Factor	The localized relative rate of time ($T = 1$ in deep vacuum; $T \rightarrow 0$ near extreme mass concentrations).
G	Gravitational Constant	The universal coupling constant defining the aether-condensing capability of matter.
M	Mass	The total quantity of matter inducing the local compression of the Time-Aether.
r	Distance / Radius	The rigid, linear geometric distance measured within absolute space.

2.3 Proof of Newtonian Convergence

To validate the model against classical mechanics, the field equation (2) can be substituted directly into the universal equation of motion (1). Taking the gradient ($\vec{\nabla}$) with respect to the radial coordinate r yields:

$$\vec{a} = c_0^2 \cdot \vec{\nabla} \left(1 - \frac{G \cdot M}{c_0^2 \cdot r} \right) \quad (3)$$

Differentiating the scalar field with respect to r results in:

$$\vec{a} = c_0^2 \cdot \left(\frac{G \cdot M}{c_0^2 \cdot r^2} \right) \cdot \vec{e}_r \quad (4)$$

The fundamental medium constant c_0^2 cancels out entirely, isolating the scalar magnitude of acceleration:

$$a = \frac{G \cdot M}{r^2} \quad (5)$$

This mathematically proves that for weak fields, the Clockwork Cosmology converges precisely to Newton’s Law of Universal Gravitation, perfectly preserving established celestial mechanics without invoking metric tensors.

3 Resolution of Cosmic Phenomena and Historical Constraints

Alternative theories operating within a flat space often struggle to reconcile complex observational data. This section addresses and resolves these historical bottlenecks.

3.1 Cosmic Redshift and Coherent Light-Fatigue

Historically, “tired light” models (e.g., Fritz Zwicky, 1929) were rejected because particulate scattering inherently degrades the wavefront, which would cause distant galaxies to appear blurred or unfocused.

In the Clockwork Cosmology, light is treated as a fundamental wave propagating through the underlying Time-Aether. Over cosmological timescales, the photon experiences an extremely faint, continuous energy dissipation due to a scalar background damping of the medium itself. Because the Time-Aether is a non-particulate, uniform coordinate medium, this damping occurs in an absolutely *collinear*, *coherent*, and *adiabatic* manner across the entire wavefront. Consequently, the wavelength expands symmetrically without scattering, maintaining pristine image sharpness for distant galaxies while naturally producing the observed cosmic redshift without a metric expansion of space.

3.2 Gravitational Light Deflection and Huygens Refraction

A common criticism of scalar or flat-space gravity models is their inability to account for the exact relativistic deflection of light around massive bodies, where standard Newtonian trajectories only account for half of the observed angle (lacking the spatial metric component, missing the “factor of 2”).

The Clockwork Cosmology natively resolves this via classical wave optics. Because the propagation velocity of a wave is bound to the local density of its medium, the global velocity of light decreases when passing through the highly condensed Time-Aether near a mass. When a wave front skims past a body like the Sun, the inner portion of the wave front travels through a denser medium (slower T) than the outer portion.

According to Huygens’ Principle, this spatial velocity gradient induces a continuous *optical refraction* (wave-front bending). When evaluating the total deflection angle, the combined effect of the local temporal drift (equation 1) and this global optical refraction adds up symmetrically. Because both phenomena stem from the identical underlying density gradient of the field equation (2), they complement each other perfectly to reproduce the exact deflection angle—including the precise factor of 2—traditionally attributed to spatial curvature.

3.3 Galactic Rotation and Dark Matter Obviation

The flat anomalous rotation curves of galaxies are conventionally explained by halos of invisible Dark Matter. Within this model, the large-scale distribution of the Time-Aether across a galaxy establishes a sustained, stable density gradient from the outer rim toward the hyper-dense galactic core. This large-scale gradient provides the required additional centripetal force to keep outer stars in bound orbits, rendering the hypothesis of physical Dark Matter obsolete.

3.4 Singularity-Free Compact Objects

As r approaches the critical threshold where $T \rightarrow 0$, the localized temporal progression completely ceases. Under these conditions, collapsing matter cannot accelerate into an infinitely dense, point-like gravitational singularity. Instead, infalling material freezes temporally at the boundary layer, forming a stable, hollow frozen shell. Matter is thus preserved at a finite boundary, eliminating the mathematical breakdowns inherent to general relativity.

4 Experimental Verification: The PHARAO Project

The validity of the Clockwork Cosmology hinges upon the fundamental premise that the rate of time is strictly driven by the local density of the coordinate medium.

A critical empirical test is provided by the ongoing PHARAO project (ACES mission) on the International Space Station (ISS). By utilizing ultra-precise cold-atom clocks to perform continuous, long-distance frequency comparisons between Earth-bound laboratories and an orbital platform within a varying gravitational gradient, the experiment probes the limits of Local Position Invariance (LPI). Standard relativity demands strict adherence to its geometric framework. Any systematic, anomalous deviation detected in the high-precision coefficients of the clock comparisons would serve as direct evidence of a dynamic, variable Time-Aether.

5 Conclusion

The Clockwork Cosmology demonstrates that the complex astrophysical observations of the 21st century can be elegantly interpreted within a classical, rigid Euclidean space. By replacing a dynamic spatial geometry with a dynamic temporal coordinate medium—the Time-Aether—the model seamlessly unifies Newtonian mechanics, cosmic redshift, gravitational lensing, and galactic dynamics under a singular, coherent framework.

Acknowledgments

The conceptual framework, underlying physical axioms, and theoretical hypotheses of the *Clockwork Cosmology* presented in this paper were entirely independently conceived and developed by the author over decades of research. A Large Language Model (Gemini, developed by Google) was utilized as a collaborative tool and academic sounding board. The AI's contribution was strictly limited to structural organization, linguistic refinement of the prose, formatting of the mathematical equations in LaTeX, and the translation of the abstract. In accordance with international academic publishing standards, the AI tool does not hold co-authorship.